

Recommendation: FY2027 Block Adjustments

Tallowbrook Health | Perioperative Services | 2026-09-15 | v1.0

To: Gregory Tanaka, COO; Janelle Brooks, President, Hospital Fort Bend; Victor Salinas, President, Medical Center West. From: Colleen Park, Director, Perioperative Services, on behalf of the perioperative committee. Date: September 15, 2026.

Decision requested

Approve three block changes effective with the January 2027 schedule, so surgeons and staff have more than 90 days' notice.

Recommendation

- Move one weekly half-day (four-hour) block from Hospital Fort Bend General Surgery to Hospital Fort Bend Orthopedics.
- Return one weekly half-day Medical Center West ENT block to open time.
- Keep Hospital Fort Bend Gynecology's allocation for one more quarter, with weekly release reminders, and review again in January.

Evidence

Policy PS-210 calls for review when a service is below 70% utilization for two consecutive quarters. Three services met that test in FY2026.

Fort Bend General Surgery ran at 66.7% for the year and below 70% in every quarter. It released 16.3% of its time, the highest share of any service.

West ENT ran at 63.9% for the year, between 62.6% and 65.2% each quarter.

Fort Bend Gynecology ran at 69.5%, below 70% in the last three quarters, during which one surgeon was on extended leave.

Fort Bend Orthopedics ran at 90.2% and was above 88% every quarter, and has asked twice for more time.

Block minutes summary, FY2026

The table summarizes block minutes and cases for all eleven service blocks at both hospitals for July 2025 through June 2026. Service-level figures are in the July committee deck.

Measure	Value
Measure	allocated_minutes
Unit	minutes
Total	887019
Mean	6719.8409
Records	132
Period	2025-07-01 to 2026-06-30
Measure	released_minutes
Unit	minutes
Total	87341
Mean	661.6742
Records	132
Period	2025-07-01 to 2026-06-30
Measure	available_minutes
Unit	minutes
Total	799678
Mean	6058.1667
Records	132
Period	2025-07-01 to 2026-06-30
Measure	used_minutes
Unit	minutes
Total	628973
Mean	4764.947
Records	132
Period	2025-07-01 to 2026-06-30
Measure	cases
Unit	cases
Total	4851
Mean	36.75
Records	132
Period	2025-07-01 to 2026-06-30

Block minutes by service at Medical Center West and Hospital Fort Bend, monthly for FY2026 (July 2025 to June 2026). ASC excluded.

Options considered

- Move a full-day Fort Bend General Surgery block: rejected, because General Surgery's unused time averages less than a full day per week and the service would lose needed capacity.
- Take no action: rejected for General Surgery and ENT, whose shortfall has persisted all year.
- Reallocate Gynecology now: deferred, because the shortfall coincides with a surgeon's leave.

Implications for surgeons and staff

General Surgery and ENT chiefs have reviewed the numbers and do not object to half-day changes.

Fort Bend Orthopedics will need an additional scrub technician four hours a week, which fits within the current perioperative budget. Anesthesia coverage does not change.

Next steps

- Approval by September 30.
- Perioperative Services to publish the January template by October 15.
- Next quarterly review in January 2027, including Fort Bend Gynecology.